

RUTHWIK AREPELLY

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SUMMARY

Former Founder and Head of Product with 7+ years of experience building high-trust AI systems. Expert at moving LLM pipelines from prototype to production-ready (68% to 91% acceptance). Proven track record of protecting engineering runway by killing low-value features and scaling B2B platforms to \$100K ARR. Builds production-ready AI systems — RAG pipelines, LLM evaluation frameworks, and agentic workflows — with the product discipline to define when not to ship AI.

EXPERIENCE

AI Product Manager, Community Dreams

2026 – Present

Tampa, FL — AI-assisted chatbot and decision workspace for nonprofit program management.

- Shipped an AI chatbot that replaced spreadsheet and email-based program tracking for a 6-person cross-functional team, recovering 60+ hours per month (~950 hours annually) previously lost to manual status chasing.
- Eliminated AI hallucinations and established user trust by leading the design of a RAG grounding layer over the program database — chunking strategy, tagging schema, and retrieval logic delivering instant, sourced citations without manual verification.
- Automated data-integrity monitoring via n8n workflows, surfacing 5–10 issues per week previously caught manually, and consolidated program status, AI recommendations, and next-step guidance into a single decision workspace.
- Defined the product's knowledge architecture with cross-functional stakeholders so operational systems could support future AI capabilities beyond the initial chatbot.

AI Product Manager, Stealth AI

2024 – 2026

San Francisco, CA — Receipt-intelligence engine and automated follow-up platform for SMBs.

- Prevented ~3 months of wasted engineering runway via 20+ discovery interviews and a 2-week MVP; killed a contact-enrichment feature after data showed 80% of user value came from automated follow-up reminders — saving ~\$40K before a line of production code.
- Reduced AI operating costs by 40% by reframing receipt extraction from a completeness to a reliability problem; shipped a hybrid OCR + Vision/LLM pipeline that cut manual correction time 60% and processing to ~4 seconds per receipt across 20 receipts and 172 line items.
- Grew user acceptance from 68% to 91% on a GPT-4 Vision + LLM pipeline by shipping a reasoning-transparency layer with confidence indicators — a deliberate latency tradeoff validated through 25+ user interviews.
- Built SugarShield, an ingredient-classification engine detecting hidden sugars; defined the evaluation framework on a 15-product labeled dataset (precision 1.00, recall 0.77, FPR 0.00) with a human-in-the-loop gate for production readiness.

Product Manager, Digital Connect

2018 – 2023

Hyderabad, India — Unified digital operations platform for universities and digital commerce for offline businesses.

- Consolidated fragmented university operations (payments, exam records, websites across four vendors, 7-day reconciliation delays) into a single in-house platform, leading an 8-person team to cut reconciliation to same-day for 10,000+ students.
- Launched first digital channels for offline businesses losing orders to manual processes — shipped ecommerce with UPI integration that shifted 35% of orders online and reduced duplicate operational costs ~25%.

- Drove 8 end-to-end digital launches (websites, ticketing, payment gateways) for universities and government clients, processing 50,000+ registrations and consolidating vendor dependencies.
- Coordinated emergency digital transitions during COVID, deploying Zoho and Google Workspace classrooms and training staff within weeks, retaining 80% of clients on active contracts through the lockdown.

Co-Founder & Head of Product, Photon Edu Fintech

2016 – 2018

Hyderabad, India — B2B SaaS edtech and payments platform for schools and universities.

- Co-founded and built a B2B SaaS edtech platform from zero with a 5-person team, scaling to 75+ schools, 10,000+ students, and \$100K ARR by defining product strategy and roadmap around institutional workflows.
- Secured \$100K ARR by diagnosing a 38% payment-failure rate causing silent revenue leakage and executing an emergency provider migration during the busiest enrollment cycle.
- Ran research across 20+ educational institutions, translating manual-process pain points into SaaS features that reduced administrative workload 40% and established strong product-market fit.

SKILLS

AI Systems: LLM-based products, RAG & semantic search, agentic workflows, evaluation frameworks, model observability, GPT-4 Vision, confidence-threshold tuning, human-in-the-loop review, MCP, vector databases (Chroma).

Product: 0→1 product development, product discovery, PRDs, roadmapping, prioritization, metrics & KPIs, experimentation & A/B testing, cross-functional leadership, stakeholder alignment.

Technical: Python, SQL, n8n, REST APIs, data pipelines, analytics dashboards, Git/GitHub, AWS, Zoho, Google Workspace, Notion, Miro.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MS, Business Analytics — Trine University · **BS, Computer Science** — SR University

Project Management Professional (PMP), PMBOK7 (uCertify) · IBM Data Analytics (Coursera)